Russell Dudek

INTERVIEW THESIS BRIEF • DATA & AI ENABLEMENT LEAD

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Independent candidate materials for a confidential client represented by CFS

CANDIDATE THESIS

Make data coherent. Make AI consequential.

Build one trusted operating reality, then attach AI to bounded workflows with explicit ownership, authority, adoption, and evidence.

Discovery boundary
The end client is confidential. Company-specific operating assumptions are therefore hypotheses for discovery, not claims about internal facts. The public role description supports the mandate, tensions, and questions in this brief.

ACTUAL MANDATE

Turn fragmented data and uneven AI use into a trusted, governed, adopted operating capability: centralize or connect the data foundation, normalize meaning across reporting/CRM/documents, establish standards and guardrails, translate work into AI-assisted processes, coordinate vendors, and leave durable internal ownership.

OPERATING TENSIONS

Tension	Failure on one side	Failure on the other	Leadership move
Central truth / local ownership	New central bottleneck	Persistent fragmentation	Shared definitions and governance with accountable domain owners
Speed / readiness	Tool theater and risk	Analysis paralysis	Bounded workflow slices with explicit readiness gaps
Build / change	Elegant platform, weak use	Adoption activity without capability	Engineer the data and the behavior as one operating product
Vendor / internal capability	Dependency and knowledge loss	Slow reinvention	Use vendors to accelerate; require internal ownership and reusable assets
Standards / judgment	Bureaucratic controls	Inconsistent risk decisions	Common guardrails with workflow-specific authority and escalation

DECISION ARCHITECTURE

Data
What is authoritative? Who owns meaning and quality? What can be connected, mirrored, transformed, or retired?

AI
What role should AI play? Which human decides? What evidence, review, access, and escalation are required?

Work
Where does the intervention enter the workflow? Who adopts it? Which outcome earns scale?

WHAT SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

One trusted view
Critical decisions use named sources, shared definitions, visible quality, and accountable stewardship.

AI becomes normal work
Approved interventions are retained in workflows because they are useful, governed, supported, and measured.

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INTERVIEW THESIS BRIEF • SHARED OPERATING LENS

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FOCUS OPERATING MODEL

Layer	Questions	Minimum output
F - Frame the work	What decision or workflow matters? Who owns it? What is the baseline and consequence?	Decision/workflow charter
O - Organize the data	Which sources, definitions, lineage, quality, access, and stewards are required?	Trusted data slice and exception map
C - Clarify authority	What may AI do? What must a human decide? Where are review and escalation?	Authority and guardrail contract
U - Use AI in workflow	What is the smallest useful intervention? How will people learn and repeat the behavior?	Embedded pilot and adoption mechanism
S - Scale proven patterns	What evidence warrants standardization, expansion, revision, hold, or retirement?	Portfolio decision and reusable assets

BALANCED SCORECARD

Dimension	Executive question	Illustrative signals
Trust	Can people find, understand, and rely on the data?	Owner/definition coverage, quality exceptions, lineage
Use	Does the behavior persist after launch?	Retained use, repeat behavior, champion coverage
Flow	Did the work become clearer or more efficient?	Cycle time, handoffs, error, rework, exception age
Value	Was measurable benefit realized?	Time, cost, risk, service, or growth benefit
Control	Are authority and exceptions visible?	Guardrail coverage, review, escalation, auditability
Learning	Does evidence improve the system?	Feedback-to-change time, reusable patterns, retired work

STAKEHOLDER TOPOLOGY

Executive sponsor: sets outcome and removes cross-functional barriers. **Business leaders/workflow owners:** own the decision and benefit. **Data/IT/security/legal:** establish architecture, access, controls, and platform reliability. **Users/champions:** prove workability and adoption. **Vendors/consultants:** accelerate specialist delivery while transferring knowledge. **Enablement lead:** holds the integrated operating model and portfolio cadence.

CHANGE BURDEN

Teams must stop treating data definitions, workflow ownership, human authority, adoption, and outcome evidence as technology-team details. The enablement leader must make those responsibilities lightweight, visible, and useful enough that the firm adopts them rather than routes around them.

ARCHITECTURE AND ENABLEMENT POSTURE

Data posture
Centralize discovery and policy while preserving distributed ownership. Preserve raw sources, standardize and reconcile meaning, curate decision-ready products, and expose lineage, access, and exceptions.

AI posture
Use common standards for access, approved tools, human authority, evaluation, and incident handling; apply them through workflow-specific contracts rather than generic policy alone.

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INTERVIEW THESIS BRIEF • EVIDENCE, OBJECTION, QUESTIONS

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EVIDENCE MAP

Mandate need	Verified evidence	Transfer logic
Cross-system operating integration	Vape-Jet: ERP/Odoo, CRM, Jira, Slack, telemetry, production, quality, customer and engineering workflows	Current direct ownership of making fragmented signals actionable
AI enablement and governance	DudeWorth: readiness, value/feasibility/data/adoption frameworks; agentic patterns with human judgment and evaluation	Direct design of the mechanisms the role must institutionalize
Operating cadence at scale	Amazon: Prime Pittsburgh launch, visibility, standard work, escalations, approximately five million annual second-day orders	Shows execution discipline and adoption under consequence
Quality and high-reliability control	Compunetics: engineering, manufacturing, quality, process controls, DoD/CERN/Intel/AMD stakeholders	Shows governance as practical execution, not paperwork
Distributed and regulated workflows	Cardinal and ZeusVu	Shows digital modernization, field operations, and explicit safety boundaries

STRONGEST OBJECTION

Concern
Russell has not held a formal enterprise data architect title and does not claim unsupported ownership of a production Fabric estate.

Response
Own business architecture, data meaning, priorities, governance, workflow insertion, adoption, evidence, and vendors; work hands-on within verified SQL/Python/API/ERP/CRM/AI experience; use platform specialists where depth is required.

EXECUTIVE QUESTIONS

1. Which data domain or workflow currently creates the most consequential executive uncertainty or operational rework?
2. Where should this leader personally build, and where should the leader direct internal specialists or vendors?
3. What has already been attempted with Copilot, Claude, or automation, and where did trust or adoption break?
4. Which leader will own the first workflow outcome?
5. Which regulatory, privacy, contractual, or model-risk constraints matter most?
6. What operating behavior would make the capability undeniable at twelve months?

90-SECOND INTERVIEW ANSWER

I would begin with one decision-critical workflow, align its data and ownership, state the AI role and human authority, embed the smallest useful intervention in normal work, and measure retained use plus operating outcome. The goal is not merely a successful pilot; it is a repeatable capability the firm can own.

SOURCE BASIS

Role description supplied by the candidate and public CFS posting; official CFS company and technology pages; Microsoft Fabric OneLake and medallion architecture documentation; NIST AI Risk Management Framework and Generative AI Profile. Company-specific operating ideas remain hypotheses until client discovery.